



Motorola's Shadow:

Motorola is bringing its next phone "SHADOW" into the market, as the successor for its DROID phone.

Samsung Wave

Samsung launches Wave, featuring an AMOLED screen and the open Bada OS



Android overtakes iPhone

devices, the iPhone 2G, the iPhone 3G, and the iPhone 3GS.

RIM still maintains its position though, and with a share of 36% it is clear ahead of both Android and iPhone OS. Android is now second in place with a share of 28%, while the iPhone OS lags at 21%.

While the news isn't unexpected – in fact it was always a matter of when rather than if – the fact that it has happened so fast is impressive. It

has been less than 2 years since the release of the first version of Android, which was used on very few devices. It is only with the release of Android 1.5 that the OS started appearing on devices.

In this short history, Android has gone from a few HTC phones to over two dozen phones, from half a dozen manufacturers, and with tablet and even netbook devices on the way. There is no stopping Android now!

Finally the prediction that one day the Android OS would overtake iPhone OS has come true!

Still, it is more of a testament

to the appeal of the iPhone, that it has taken dozens of devices by featuring the same Android Operating System to overtake the iPhone OS – which is only offered on three smartphone

Aircel and ibibo introduce social gaming for mobiles

Aircel, which is a joint venture between Maxis Communications Berhad of Malaysia and Sindya Securities & Investments Private Limited and which is India's fifth largest GSM mobile service provider announced on 17th May that they will be bringing Social Gaming to Mobile Customers for the first time in India. This service will allow the young gaming enthusiasts in our country to play "Great Indian Parking wars" on ibibo.com gaming website through their WAP-enabled mobile phones.

Aircel and ibibo.com will soon be offering Great Indian Parking wars on Aircel's Pocket Internet service and are planning to launch more games in the future. The customers will be able to log on to these games via their Facebook ID or ibibo.com ID to gain access to play Great Indian Parking wars.

Mr. Gurdeep Singh, COO, Aircel said, "With first social gaming on your mobile phones, the intent is to drive innovation at the convergence of games and social platforms while you are on the move. It is our endeavour to offer our consumers exciting and engaging opportunities such as gaming and staying socially connected anytime, anywhere."

Great Indian Parking Wars will allow the users to add friends to their network, buy new cars, issue challans etc. to cars parked on their street, block parking areas on others' streets and lots of such interesting in-game activities which makes this game more interesting. The game does not require the user to download anything and are free-to-play. Users can play this game on their WAP-enabled handsets via accessing Aircel Pocket Internet from Aircel WAP-enabled mobile phones.

FroYo is here

Android 2.2 or FroYo (Frozen Yogurt) was unveiled by Google at their IO 2010, event with a focus on improving the core of the OS. Major updates in Android 2.2 improve the performance of applications. First of all, there is the new Dalvik JIT compiler for Android applications with which Google expects applications on Android 2.2 to get a boost of two to five times! Secondly, Google has ported their V8 engine to Android 2.2. This, according to Google, could improve the performance of JavaScript code in the browser by as much as two to three times. Android 2.2 also includes support for Flash 10.1 and only devices running Android 2.2 will be able to run full Flash content.

For enterprise customers, Android 2.2 has some exciting new features for Exchange. Now the OS has improved security, support for Exchange Calendars, auto-discovery of settings, auto-completing email addresses

from the directory, and best of all, support for remote wipes in case the instrument is lost.

Tethering support is much improved as well, and an Android phone will be able to act as a Wi-Fi hotspot, giving up to eight other devices wireless internet access.

Android 2.2 features some new platform technologies as well, new APIs introduced in FroYo will enable applications to participate in the data backup and restore, so an application can be backed up from one device and restored to another; developers can include support for installing apps to an SD card, in which case a user could move it back and forth from the phone memory or the SD card.

Besides these, there have been some visual updates. The OS now features a new camera and gallery UI, and a revamped home screen.

Overall this release seems to have evolved the Android platform significantly despite being a simple point release. **d**